

THE PLAN OF SALVATION

"What will you do with Jesus?"

Primary Text: Acts 2:36-42 | Topical / Expository-Topical | 40 Minutes

PROPOSITION	God has revealed through the gospel how sinners come to Christ: hear His Word, believe His Son, repent of sin, confess Christ, be baptized into Christ, and live in faithful obedience.
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INTRODUCTION - SALVATION BEGINS WITH GOD

A. God acted first.

John 3:16 - "God so loved the world, that he gave..." *Romans 5:8* - "while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us."
Ephesians 2:4-9 - salvation is grounded in God's mercy and grace, not human merit.
Titus 2:11-12 - grace that saves also teaches the redeemed how to live.

CONTEXT / AUTHORITY	DC: Ephesians 2 contrasts death in sin with God's action in making sinners alive with Christ. I: Salvation originates in God's grace; obedient response cannot be treated as meritorious self-salvation.
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B. The Great Commission establishes the gospel response.

Matthew 28:18-20 - disciples are made, baptized, and taught continued obedience.
Mark 16:15-16 - gospel preached → believed → baptized → salvation promised.
Luke 24:46-47 - death and resurrection → repentance and remission preached → beginning at Jerusalem.

CONTEXT	RC: Luke 24 points forward to Jerusalem. A	AUTHORITY	C: Christ commands gospel proclamation, baptism, and continued implementation of that commission.
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C. Acts 2 - the commission put into practice.

Peter preaches Jesus - His life, crucifixion, resurrection, exaltation, and lordship. The hearers are "pricked in their heart" and ask, "What shall we do?" Peter answers: "Repent, and be baptized..." Those receiving the word are baptized and then "continued stedfastly."

HISTORICAL / EXEGETICAL	Pentecost in Jerusalem is not an isolated proof text. Luke 24:47 designated Jerusalem as the beginning point. Acts 2 records that promised beginning and shows how the apostles preached the response to the risen Christ.
SERMON ROADMAP	Hear His Word → Believe His Son → Repent of Sin → Confess His Name → Be Baptized into Christ → Obey Him Faithfully.

→ What will you do with Jesus?

I. HEAR HIS WORD

Romans 10:17 - "faith cometh by hearing..."

- A. Faith requires revelation. Romans 10:14 asks, "how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard?"
- B. The content heard is the gospel of Christ. 1 Corinthians 15:3-4 centers it upon His death, burial, and resurrection.
- C. The Plan of Salvation must never replace the Man of salvation: Jesus died. Jesus was buried. Jesus arose. Jesus reigns.

CONTEXT / AUTHORITY	DC: Romans 10 reasons from calling → belief in the revealed message.	TOTAL CONTEXT	Isaiah 55:3; Matthew 13:23; Acts 2:37; 8:5-6; 16:14; 18:8; Romans 10:17
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→ HEAR HIS WORD.

II. BELIEVE HIS SON

John 8:24 - "if ye believe not that I am he, ye shall die in your sins."

- A. Biblical faith is more than intellectual acknowledgment. James 2:19 - "the devils also believe, and tremble."
- B. Hebrews 11 repeatedly presents faith acting: Abel offered; Noah prepared; Abraham obeyed.

LANGUAGE / WORD STUDY	pisteuo (believe) expresses believing, trusting, or placing confidence in. In Scripture, faith is not merely agreeing that a proposition is true; it entrusts itself to God and responds to His Word.		
AUTHORITY	C: Jesus requires belief (John 8:24). E: Heresy contradicts the biblical character of faith.	APOLOGETIC	"Faith alone" must not be defined as mental assent. The issue is not faith versus a redefined faith that excludes the response God commands.

→ BELIEVE HIS SON.

III. REPENT OF SIN

Acts 17:30 - God "commandeth all men every where to repent."

- A. Luke 13:3 - "except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish."
- B. 2 Corinthians 7:10 - "godly sorrow worketh repentance..." Sorrow may produce repentance; sorrow itself is not repentance.

LANGUAGE / WORD STUDY	metanoeo (repent) describes a change of mind. Biblical usage does not leave that change abstract: the changed mind produces a changed direction toward God.		
CONTEXT / AUTHORITY	DC: Acts 17 confronts idolatrous hearers in Athens to repent.	APPLICATION	You cannot continue walking away from God while claiming to be His people.

→ REPENT OF SIN.

IV. CONFESS HIS NAME

Matthew 10:32 - "Whosoever therefore shall confess me before men..."

- A. Romans 10:9-10 joins belief in the risen Christ with confession of the Lord Jesus.
- B. Confession is not merely repeating a ceremonial sentence. It openly acknowledges allegiance to Jesus.
- C. The confession declares: **Jesus is the Christ. Jesus is the Son of God. Jesus is Lord.**

LANGUAGE / WORD STUDY	homologeō (confess) carries the idea of acknowledging or declaring agreement. Christian confession publicly identifies the believer with the truth about Jesus.		
HISTORICAL / CULTURAL	Calling Jesus Lord was not empty religious the risen Christ.	AUTHORITY	C: Christ requires confession before men. I: Genuine inward faith intentionally concealed.

→ CONFESS HIS NAME.

V. BE BAPTIZED INTO CHRIST

Galatians 3:27 - "baptized into Christ have put on Christ."

- A. Notice the direction: **INTO CHRIST**. Romans 6:3 likewise says "baptized into Jesus Christ" and "into his death."
- B. Romans 6 gives the gospel picture: Christ **died** → **was buried** → **arose**. The believer **dies to sin** → **is buried in baptism** → **rises to newness of life**.
- C. Acts 2:38 - "Repent, and be baptized... for the remission of sins."
- D. Acts 22:16 - "arise, and be baptized, and wash away thy sins..."
- E. 1 Peter 3:21 explicitly connects baptism with salvation while denying that its significance is merely washing dirt from the body.

LANGUAGE / EXEGESIS	baptizō describes immersion/submersion. Romans 6 uses burial and resurrection imagery to explain baptism's relationship to Christ's death and the believer's new life.		
CONTEXT / AUTHORITY	DC: Acts 2:38 directly answers convicted hearer's anticipated repentance/remission beginning	TOTAL CONTEXT	Matthew 28:19; Mark 16:16; Acts 2:38-41; 8:12,35-39; 10:47-48; Galatians 3:27; Colossians 2:12; 1 Peter 3:21.

→ BE BAPTIZED INTO CHRIST.

V. BE BAPTIZED INTO CHRIST - APOLOGETIC / CONVERSION EVIDENCE

The Ethiopian - Acts 8:35-38. Philip “preached unto him Jesus.” The eunuch then asks about baptism. **Necessary inference:** preaching Jesus included enough teaching concerning baptism for the hearer to recognize his need to obey.

Saul - Acts 22:16. After encountering Christ, believing, fasting, and praying, Saul is still told to arise, be baptized, and wash away his sins.

Cornelius - Acts 10-11. The Holy Spirit’s miraculous outpouring demonstrated Gentile acceptance; Peter nevertheless “commanded them to be baptized.” The miracle did not eliminate baptism.

Philippian Jailer - Acts 16:30-34. “Believe” is followed by the Word being preached; he is baptized “the same hour of the night.” The complete narrative must govern the interpretation of verse 31.

APOLOGETIC	Baptism is not trusting in water or earning salvation; it is saving work through the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ.	1 PETER 3:21	Peter himself prevents a materialistic reading: baptism is not tied to the resurrection of Jesus Christ.
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VI. OBEY HIM FAITHFULLY

Acts 2:42 - “And they continued stedfastly...”

A. Baptism is not the finish line. The baptized disciples immediately enter a continuing life of doctrine, fellowship, breaking of bread, and prayers.

B. **Matthew 28:20** - baptized disciples are taught “to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you.”

C. **Hebrews 5:9** - Christ is “the author of eternal salvation unto all them that obey him.”

D. **Revelation 2:10** - “be thou faithful unto death...”

CONTEXT / AUTHORITY	E: Acts 2:42 shows newly baptized Christians; command continued obedience and faithfulness.	TOTAL CONTEXT	Matthew 10:22; 24:13; John 8:31; 15:4-10; Acts 14:22; Romans 12:1-2; James 1:12; 2 Peter 1:5-11; Revelation 14:12-13.
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The Christian life: Saved → Transformed → Serving → Growing → Enduring → Faithful.

→ **OBEY HIM FAITHFULLY.**

CONCLUSION - WHAT WILL YOU DO WITH JESUS?

The question is not, “Do you know the six steps?” One may memorize six steps and never surrender to Christ. The question is: **What will you do with Jesus?**

SERMON REFRAIN	Hear His Word. Believe His Son. Repent of Sin. Confess His Name. Be Baptized into Christ. Obey Him Faithfully.
GOSPEL INVITATION	God provided the grace. Christ provided the blood. The Spirit revealed the Word. The gospel provides the message. Now respond to Jesus according to His Word.

→ **WHAT WILL YOU DO WITH JESUS?**